

Maths Adventure for National Science Week: The Lost Treasure of Coral Bay

Year 3 · National Science Week Special

ACARA V9.0 — AC9M3N03, AC9M3N04, AC9M3N06 (Number: addition, subtraction, multiplication, division and mathematical modelling)

Ahoy, Maths Explorer! Captain Ruby's treasure map was torn apart in a wild storm off the coast of Coral Bay! She has found four scattered map pieces — but each one is locked behind a maths clue. Solve every clue correctly, crack the final code, and help Captain Ruby find the lost treasure before the tide comes in!

Learning Intention: Students will solve addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division word problems, and use their answers to crack a numerical code.

Warm-Up: Ready Your Sea Legs

$15 + 8 = \underline{\quad}$

$42 - 17 = \underline{\quad}$

$6 \times 3 = \underline{\quad}$

$20 \div 4 = \underline{\quad}$

The Adventure: Solve the Map Clues

CLUE 1 · ADDITION

Captain Ruby found 24 gold coins in one chest and 18 gold coins in another. How many gold coins does she have altogether?

Answer:

CLUE 2 · ADDITION

The ship sailed 156 km on Monday and 89 km on Tuesday. How far did it sail in total?

Answer: km

CLUE 3 · SUBTRACTION (MONEY)

Ruby had \$50 to spend on rope and supplies. She spent \$27. How much money does she have left?

Answer: \$

CLUE 4 · MULTIPLICATION

There are 6 pirates on the crew, and each pirate needs 3 coconuts for the journey. How many coconuts are needed in total?

Answer:

CLUE 5 · MULTIPLICATION (MEASUREMENT)

The treasure is buried 4 times as deep as Ruby's shovel is long. Her shovel is 25 cm long. How deep is the treasure buried?

Answer: cm

CLUE 6 · TIME

Ruby left the ship at 9:15am. The walk to the treasure took 45 minutes. What time did she arrive?

Answer:

Unlock the Treasure Chest

Take the **ones digit** from your answers to Clues 1, 2, 3, and 4. Write them in order to reveal the 4-digit lock code!

Clue 1 → Clue 2 → Clue 3 → Clue 4

Challenge: Sharing the Treasure

Captain Ruby wants to share **237 gold coins** equally between herself and her 4 crew members (5 people in total). How many coins does each pirate get, and how many coins are left over?

Each pirate gets:

Left over:

Bonus Challenge: Sailing Around the Island

The treasure island is shaped like a triangle. Each side measures **12 km**. What is the total distance around the island (the perimeter)?

Answer:

km

Design Your Own Pirate Coin

You found the treasure! Design your own gold coin below and give it a name.

Case Status

Clues solved correctly: ___ / 6



Treasure
Found!



So Close — Try
Again

Parent/Teacher Tip: Let students check their own working using inverse operations (e.g. use subtraction to check an addition answer) before revealing whether their code is correct — it builds the habit of self-checking, not just answer-getting.

For teachers and parents: use this page to check student responses.

Warm-Up Answers

$15 + 8 = 23$ $42 - 17 = 25$ $6 \times 3 = 18$ $20 \div 4 = 5$

Adventure Clue Answers

Clue 1: $24 + 18 = 42$ gold coins

Clue 2: $156 + 89 = 245$ km

Clue 3: $\$50 - \$27 = \$23$

Clue 4: $6 \times 3 = 18$ coconuts

Clue 5: $25 \times 4 = 100$ cm (1 metre)

Clue 6: $9:15\text{am} + 45 \text{ minutes} = 10:00\text{am}$

Treasure Chest Code

Ones digit of Clue 1 (42) → **2** Clue 2 (245) → **5** Clue 3 (23) → **3** Clue 4 (18) → **8**

Final Code: 2 - 5 - 3 - 8

Challenge & Bonus Answers

Sharing the Treasure: $237 \div 5 = 47$ coins each, with **2** coins left over.

Sailing Around the Island: $12 + 12 + 12 = 36$ km.